

# SOF NSO Science — Topic Deep-Dive: Transport & Communication

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

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## 1. What is transport?

**Transport** means carrying people and goods from one place to another. There are three kinds, based on where they travel.

| Type                   | Travels on/in   | Examples                                            |
|------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Land transport</b>  | Roads and rails | Car, bus, train, cycle, auto-rickshaw, bullock cart |
| <b>Water transport</b> | Water           | Boat, ship, steamer                                 |
| <b>Air transport</b>   | Air (sky)       | Aeroplane, helicopter                               |

**Remember:** a ship travels on **water**, an aeroplane travels in the **air**, and a bus travels on **land**.

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## 2. Fast and slow

Different vehicles travel at different speeds.

| Fastest → Slowest | Example                       |
|-------------------|-------------------------------|
| Fastest           | <b>Aeroplane</b>              |
| Fast              | Train, car                    |
| Slow              | Bicycle                       |
| Slowest           | <b>Bullock cart</b> , walking |

To travel a long distance quickly (like Delhi to Chennai in one day), the **aeroplane** is best. To cross a river with no bridge, a **boat** is best.

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## 3. Fuels

Most vehicles need **fuel** to move: - Cars, buses, motorbikes → **petrol or diesel**. - Aeroplanes → a special fuel (aviation fuel). - A **bicycle** needs **no fuel** — we move it with our own leg power.

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## 4. What is communication?

**Communication** means sharing news, messages or ideas with others. Long ago people sent messages by **letters** carried by post, which took many days. Today we have fast ways too.

| Means                     | What it is                           |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Letter</b>             | A written message sent by post       |
| <b>Telephone / mobile</b> | Talk to someone far away at once     |
| <b>Television (TV)</b>    | Watch news and shows                 |
| <b>Newspaper</b>          | Read the daily news                  |
| <b>Internet / e-mail</b>  | Send messages and see people quickly |
| <b>Radio</b>              | Listen to news and music             |

## 5. Personal and mass communication

| Type            | Meaning                                   | Examples                             |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Personal</b> | Message to <b>one</b> person (one-to-one) | A letter to one friend, a phone call |
| <b>Mass</b>     | Reaches <b>many</b> people at once        | Newspaper, TV, radio                 |

So a private letter or phone call is **personal**; a TV news channel or newspaper is **mass** communication.

To send a **written message quickly** to one cousin today, an **e-mail or phone message on the internet** is best — a posted letter would take days.

### Common traps

| The trap                                           | The truth                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| "An aeroplane travels on water"                    | It travels in the <b>air</b>                             |
| "A ship travels on land"                           | A ship travels on <b>water</b>                           |
| "A bicycle needs petrol"                           | A bicycle needs <b>no fuel</b> — we pedal it             |
| "A newspaper is personal communication"            | A newspaper is <b>mass</b> communication                 |
| "A phone call to one person is mass communication" | It is <b>personal</b> (one-to-one)                       |
| "A bullock cart is the fastest"                    | The <b>aeroplane</b> is the fastest; the cart is slowest |

### High-frequency question types

1. **Classify transport:** "A ship is \_\_\_\_ transport" → water.
2. **Fastest/slowest:** "Which is the fastest?" → aeroplane.
3. **Fuel:** "Cars run on \_\_\_\_" → petrol/diesel.
4. **Means of communication:** "We read the news in a \_\_\_\_" → newspaper.
5. **Personal vs mass:** "TV news to many people is \_\_\_\_ communication" → mass.
6. **Best choice:** "To cross a river with no bridge, use a \_\_\_\_" → boat.

### Key facts checklist

- ☐ Land transport: car, bus, train, cycle.
- ☐ Water transport: boat, ship.
- ☐ Air transport: aeroplane, helicopter.
- ☐ Aeroplane = fastest; bullock cart = slowest.
- ☐ Cars/buses use petrol or diesel; a cycle needs no fuel.
- ☐ Communication: letter, telephone, TV, newspaper, internet, radio.
- ☐ Personal = one person (letter, phone call).
- ☐ Mass = many people (newspaper, TV, radio).

### Quick drill (10 questions)

1. A ship travels on \_\_\_\_.
2. An aeroplane travels in the \_\_\_\_.
3. A bus travels on \_\_\_\_.
4. Which is the fastest way to travel far?
5. Which is the slowest: aeroplane or bullock cart?
6. Cars and buses run on which fuel?
7. Which vehicle needs no fuel?

8. We read the daily news in a \_\_\_\_.
9. A phone call to one person is \_\_\_\_ communication.
10. A TV news channel reaching many people is \_\_\_\_ communication.

**Answers:** 1. Water 2. Air 3. Land 4. Aeroplane 5. Bullock cart 6. Petrol or diesel 7. Bicycle 8. Newspaper 9. Personal  
10. Mass